

Chapter 4 Quote Strips: Obedience

Page 1 of 3 | Authority, rules, enforcement, reliability, trust, and the piaw–piaw soldier.

O01

Jonathan McDermott (interview, school leader)

You are in the space and based on how the area is set up, you have to do whatever you are sent to do, the obedience to listen when you are spoken to, and to follow instructions without question. But I can say for the majority [of recruits], they are not used to being unquestionably obedient. And it takes them a while to adjust to that type of discipline.

O02

Nkrumah Maroon (focus group, instructor)

Discipline for me is, I use the universal definition, which is training someone to obey by using punishment.

O03

Erin Sharpe (interview, school leader)

My construct of discipline at the time was just to follow instructions, to follow orders.

O04

Jonathan McDermott (interview, school leader)

I think discipline was derived from authority.

O05

Kwame Dawn (focus group, instructor)

If e discipline bruk dung, higher authority can bring it back.

O06

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

Perhaps the most governed individuals inna Jamaica by the amount o' rules.

O07

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

The Green Book.

O08

Bob Wellington (interview, school leader)

Do's and Don'ts are mainly briefed and are not always kept in hand for re-reading.

O09

Chaz Stonegrill (interview, school leader)

Not a written rule, but becomes clear when someone fails to meet it.

O10

Passion Purpose (interview, school leader)

It is something not necessarily have to be written, there can be unwritten rules. If we were to write everything, then we would have a problem.

O11

Erin Sharpe (interview, school leader)

If the instructor said jump, I would want to know how high, how long, and just jump. I believe that if the persons who are set above me have intent to make me better, then what they're instilling in me should be to make me better.

O12

Ramon Brown (interview, instructor)

Rank carries a certain level of authority that is assumed, yet higher authority can undermine it. If this person does nothing, disrespect can spread like wildfire.

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O13

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

It's not a rank that makes a person. A person makes rank.

O14

Ramon Brown (interview, instructor)

You treat your authority like it's a garden to be nurtured. You tactically do things to ensure that it stays with you. You have to find creative ways of ensuring that at all times discipline is maintained.

O15

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

I was speaking to some mothers from [name of community redacted] who were asking me about their sons joining the JDF [Jamaican military] to learn some discipline. I said to them, discipline is not really taught in the JDF. Discipline is enforced. It's in the enforcing or in the enforcement of discipline that people start learning and understanding that this place requires you to be disciplined. And if yuh slip up, yuh get mash up [get punished / dealt with harshly].

O16

Obael Stormstrong (interview, instructor)

Dem haffi show wi that level of trust, just the same.

O17

Ramon Brown (focus group, instructor)

Discipline can also speak to you as the enforcement requiring you conforming and not just you teaching someone to conform.

O18

Chaz Stonegrill (interview, school leader)

In order for them to trust in what we do, we have to be viewed as professionals with the discipline.

O19

Marley Thunder (focus group, instructor)

When e discipline bruk dung now e damage e trust weh dem have fi wi.

O20

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

Yuh can't put nuh piaw–piaw soldier to go do [that] ... dem haffi be well disciplined.

O21

Kevin Jewinsky (interview, school leader)

Even small lapse can throw off the whole thing.

O22

Kevin Jewinsky (interview, school leader)

Ah jus' so di Army ting set.

O23

Jonathan McDermott (focus group, school leader)

Discipline need, um, a structure; and that is why the army is designed the way it is.

O24

Kwame Dawn (interview, instructor)

Di army don't work so.

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O25

Lee Brown (interview, school leader)

We would have the worst army in the world right now.

Chapter 4 Quote Strips: Internalisation

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101

Dwayne Andrews (focus group, school leader)

In its raw form it is not codified. It is innate. It is natural. A baby just born, a blank slate. The first thing the baby does is cry. And the next thing, him probably ah move towards ah breast. So is a survival. How him know sey fi move to di breast? Because there are certain stimuli that are there that are innate. Certain things are within us, like our five senses. There are several others that we are blinded about. It is a built-in.

102

Anara Birdsong (focus group, school leader)

Not to cut you, but I would tend to disagree with the idea that it is innate. It is all depending on the condition in which he or she has been brought up: culture, atmosphere, community. So yes, we can get somebody who is zero discipline here; to what we expect as military beings. But it is not that they have zero. It is just that what they have been exposed to.

103

Kwame Dawn (interview, instructor)

Mi feel disrupt' because mi always wonder: how dem fi super indisciplined, as dem reach?

104

Anthony Jackson (interview, instructor)

Now when yuh disciplined, yuh ah go put out 60% every day, every day, every day. And with that 60%, yuh develop consistency, and yuh see progress. I think discipline is really just the ability to self-regulate.

105

Anaya Redemption (interview, school leader)

There's always a goal. I want to lose 10 pounds. I have to do my diet and start doing exercise. I need to exercise three times daily. I might not like to exercise, but the goal is to lose 10 pounds. So, I persist, even though I don't want to. If it is ambiguous, it's not a goal. It's just 'I want to try that'.

106

Marcus Black (interview, school leader)

We are creatures of habits. Drill being repetitive in nature will cause us to automatically change. Over time, it becomes almost ingrained. Developing brain memory and muscle memory.

107

Passion Purpose (interview, school leader)

As a recruit, I didn't need my instructor to tell me to get my uniform ready. I didn't have to wait on a duty roster to know that the bathrooms are to wash.

108

Anara Birdsong (focus group, school leader)

Yuh know how much things recruits think but the don't act? Dem jus' roll ... crawl ... and conform.

109

Obael Stormstrong (interview, instructor)

Discipline is not a feeling. Discipline nuh have time and place. Discipline is supposed to be ingrained in you, so even if you feel like not to, you're going to. It is you controlling yourself, no matter what, the time, the season. If this is what you should do, this is what you will do. It is not when you feel like; discipline is right through.

Chapter 4 Quote Strips: Internalisation

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I10

Anara Birdsong (focus group, school leader)

I will add that fear of punishment, however, and 'do this, you will be able to achieve this'. 'Pass out' [graduate]. 'Tun [become] a soldier'.

I11

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

So discipline ah di ability fi behave in a controlled environment. Self-discipline wudda refer more to yourself. You are the environment. Your rules. Your principles.

I12

Unspecified participant judgement (reported judgement, participant)

Him never have deh self-control deh.

I13

Erin Sharpe (interview, school leader)

They are disciplined enough to dot each 'I' and cross each 'T' to do the wrong, but they don't have the self-control to say no.

I14

Erin Sharpe (interview, school leader)

They're very disciplined for what they want: gang members, they come in, they conform. They're disciplined enough to conform to our system. be the enemy within. For the purpose of intel gathering.

I15

Marco Wolf (interview, school leader)

When they come in the work, these are the soldiers that will steal the pick-up, steal a rifle, or rounds. We try to sift these persons out within the training. MIU [military intelligence unit] might have missed these persons.

I16

Malayo Montanas (interview, instructor)

Discipline cover a variety of things. Discipline is good and discipline is bad. A 'gun man' [an armed criminal in Jamaican usage] can be one of the most disciplined people in terms of his self-control. Him master him craft.

I17

Jonathan McDermott (interview, school leader)

There's discipline in every aspect of their everyday life. Discipline is wide.

I18

Erin Sharpe (interview, school leader)

My father started out by teaching us how to save that you only needed just enough, there was no need to kind of take what is not yours. Discipline, now, is also about your resources and not wasting, not just turning up; it is in everything that you do.

I19

Anthony Jackson (interview, instructor)

One of the major things people want to free themselves from right now is poverty. If you disciplined with your financial spending, it ah go become easier to free yourself from poverty.

I20

Lee Brown (interview, school leader)

Most of the times when I talk to them, it's mostly girlfriend, money problem, dem nuh have nuh money discipline. My money problem was m spending my money foolishly – giving females, three or four females mi ah date, forget about myself, 'cause mi think ah love. When I reached up, get [rank redacted], I start to discipline myself. Mi seh to dem, 'if you ask mi for a money mi give you 5, accept it. Mi assist you. Have a money discipline. Fix yourself.

Chapter 4 Quote Strips: Internalisation

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I21

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

The persons who came here, you can tell the homes. They came with some level of discipline. The first thing I ask them: were you a cadet? You don't have to tell them to stand to attention, to say 'sir'. Very sharp. I personally think, with the small things: when you fulfil the small things, you can be depended on to fulfill the larger things.

I22

Kevin Grant (interview, instructor)

Discipline in the home and discipline in the military are two different disciplines. Very different.

I23

Chaz Stonegrill (interview, school leader)

I believe that it stems initially, originally from the home – that first socialisation. Your values. I believe those are also hard to change. So if we don't catch these things in the bud, it might be difficult to correct their way of thinking, because it's associated with their beliefs – and beliefs are difficult to change.

I24

Marco Wolf (interview, school leader)

I think it has to do with a lot of things. It's not a singular activity. Timeliness. Self-esteem. Community. Environment. Who they interact with on a daily basis. They can be disciplined in one aspect but indisciplined in a next, which would be an 'integrity' issue – because it is what they are doing when somebody else is watching.

Chapter 4 Quote Strips: Performativity

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P01

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

Some will naturally be guided by their goals or wanting to become a soldier. They say, 'hey, nuh dig dis yah inno [I don't dig this], so mi ah go be ah Hummingbird, while I'm here, fi get to weh mi want go, to get by'.

P02

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

Yuh have di Hummingbird now, which wudda l Jamaica national bird, which we wudda find with such quality and standard. And den now, e Ja weh nuh care, eat anything: see a rat deh, pic pick him up and gone. Whilst e Hummingbird likkle flowers, give back to nature itself.

P03

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

Recruit training is the most where discipline comes out, because this is the only part in Arm career where you're under so much lock and k and guarded. You're being watched by so mar many persons. So automatically, a person car up an image, a character, or persona, to fit in whilst he's here. And then when you leave he turn back into a Jankro. Di likkle Jankro mentality start to come out.

P04

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

Sharp and hard.

P05

James Bond (interview, school leader)

Dress and deportment, highest standard, a disciplined individual.

P06

Jonathan McDermott (interview, school leader)

Neatness is often associated with discipline, and it works on the mind.

P07

Obael Stormstrong (interview, instructor)

Mannerisms, display, etiquettes.

P08

Paris May (interview, school leader)

Discipline is a bit in the gray.

P09

Paris May (interview, school leader)

Leeway.

P10

Paris May (interview, school leader)

The person in charge of me doesn't even know v the standard is.

P11

Zion Bamboo (focus group, school leader)

The undisciplined disciplinarian looks disciplined when he's to lead but when he's to follow him gone rogue.

P12

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

If yuh slip up, yuh get mash up.

Chapter 4 Quote Strips: Performativity

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P13

Marco Wolf (interview, school leader)

Discipline goes hand in hand with positive or negative reinforcements. Rigid. Consequence

P14

Lee Brown (interview, school leader)

We just maintain the standard weh dem want.

P15

Black Lion (interview, instructor)

People work with weh dem eyes see more than weh dem hear.

P16

Obael Stormstrong (interview, instructor)

You can't be real disciplined if it's only when you're around me. It's probably eye-service, e servant ting, because you see the crowd.

P17

Obael Stormstrong (interview, instructor)

If it's a case where you only run when you have BFST [fitness test] or PT [physical fitness training], you try and push out your all, because you see the crowd. Is it a case that we can say you're really disciplined though? Or you're just motivated? Because motivation is different from discipline.

P18

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

When you leave here, in the wider force, he's under much pressure as he would be here.

P19

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

Do you realise that everything you do is judged by your core values? Do you recognise that these are the things that write your military service? If you are not disciplined, you can't be honest because it takes discipline to be honest.

P20

Dwayne Andrews (focus group, school leader)

They think that discipline is the master of them all; yuh can't have Courage without it. Yuh can't have Commitment. Honour. Integrity. Loyalty. The other character traits are there. They're all ingrained in the Discipline.

P21

Imani Storm (interview, school leader)

Turn back into a Jankro. Di likkle Jankro mentality start to come out.

P22

Jeremiah Black (interview, school leader)

In that absence, they fill it with something, the recruits.

P23

Kevin Jewinsky (interview, school leader)

No, it's not about look good when the TO [training officer] comes. It has to be that inna your sight too, it has to actually be good.

P24

Kwame Dawn (interview / focus group, instructor)

Discipline ah nuh jus' sup'n weh yuh talk 'bout. It all ah go boil down to, as we love to say in the military, doing the right thing even when no one is looking.

Chapter 4 Quote Strips: Performativity

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P25

Jonathan McDermott (interview, school leader)

They have the JDF [Jamaican military] in particular as this high discipline institution and once they see a member, there's that high expectation of discipline and a certain mannerism that they expect and if they don't see that being portrayed it's as if they would be disappointed.